

Make-up Water Systems: Compliance, SOP & Optimization Guide

Purpose:

Replenishes losses in steam, hydronic, or cooling systems while maintaining water quality and system balance.

Why It's Ignored:

Often automated and unmonitored, leading to leaks, overfeeding, or quality issues.

Must-Have Docs:

- Daily meter readings
- Backflow preventer test logs
- Water treatment compatibility logs
- SOPs for flushing and feed valve control

Compliance Officials:

EPASDWA, ASSE, Local Plumbing Code, OSHA 1910.141

PPE Required:

Gloves, goggles, meter access tool (if recessed)

Installation Practices:

- Water meter installed and read regularly
- Backflow preventer installed and labeled
- Pressure-reducing valve tuned
- Feed line visibly separate and accessible

Must Checks:

- Feed rate vs. normal evaporation or loss
- Backflow preventer leak or drip
- Meter reading trends
- Cross-connection risk

Regulations & Codes:

EPA Safe Drinking Water Act, ASSE 1013, IPC